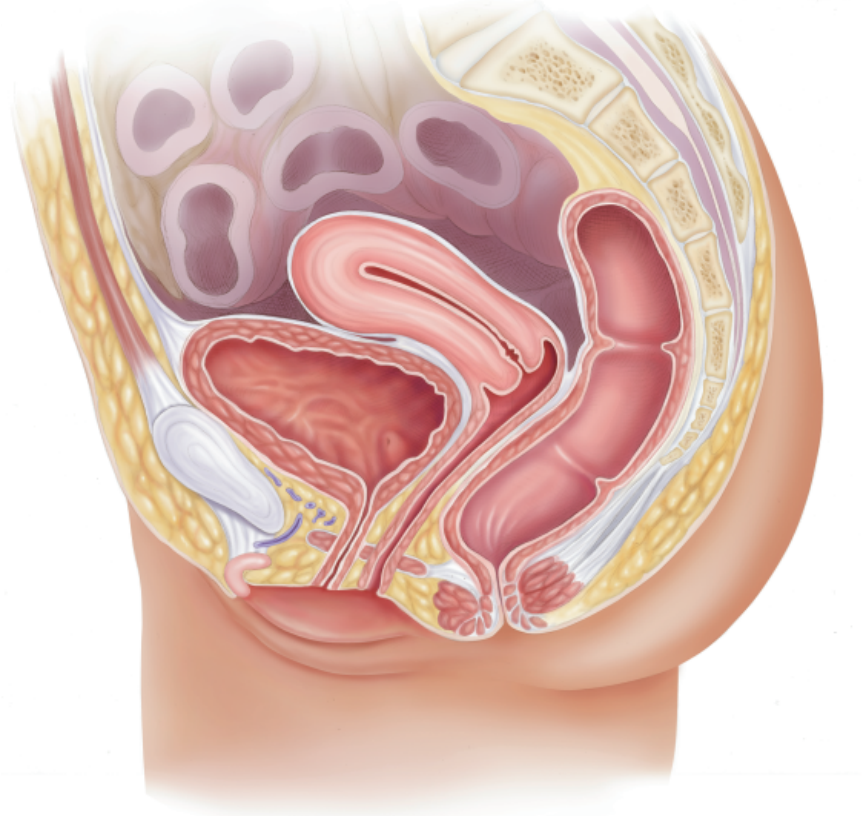
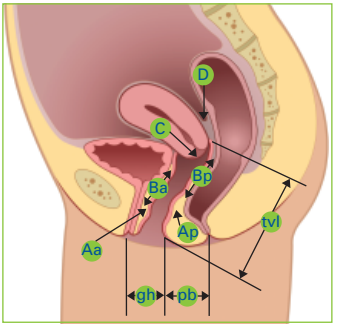
Pelvic Organ Prolapse



A Pocket Reference Guide

POP-Q Exam—A Quick Reference Guide



The pelvic organ prolapse quantification (POP-Q) exam is used to quantify, describe, and stage pelvic support.

- There are 6 points measured at the vagina with respect to the hymen.
- Points above the hymen are negative numbers; points below the hymen are positive numbers.

Point	Description	Range of Values
Aa	Anterior vaginal wall 3 cm proximal to the hymen	-3 cm to +3 cm
Ba	Most distal position of the remaining upper anterior vaginal wall	-3 cm to + tvl
C	Most distal edge of cervix or vaginal cuff scar	
D	Posterior fornix (N/A if post-hysterectomy)	
Ap	Posterior vaginal wall 3 cm proximal to the hymen	-3 cm to +3 cm
Bp	Most distal position of the remaining upper posterior vaginal wall	-3 cm to + tvl

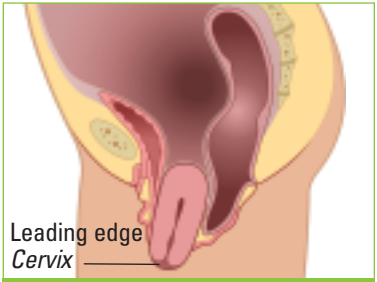
Genital hiatus (gh)—Measured from middle of external urethral meatus to posterior midline hymen
Perineal body (pb)—Measured from posterior margin of gh to middle of anal opening
Total vaginal length (tvl)—Depth of vagina when point D or C is reduced to normal position

POP-Q Staging Criteria	
Stage 0	Aa, Ap, Ba, Bp = -3 cm and C or D ≤ – (tvl – 2) cm
Stage I	Stage 0 criteria not met and leading edge < -1 cm
Stage II	Leading edge ≥ -1 cm but ≤ +1 cm
Stage III	Leading edge > +1 cm but < + (tvl – 2) cm
Stage IV	Leading edge ≥ + (tvl – 2) cm

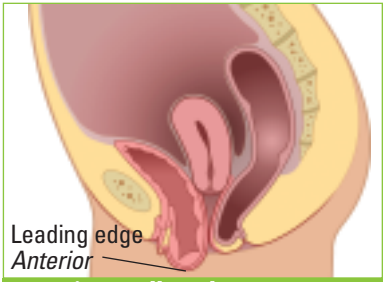
Reference: Bump RC, Mattiasson A, Bo K, et al. The standardization of terminology of female pelvic organ prolapse and pelvic floor dysfunction. *Am J Obstet Gynecol.* 1996;175:13.

Pelvic Organ Prolapse

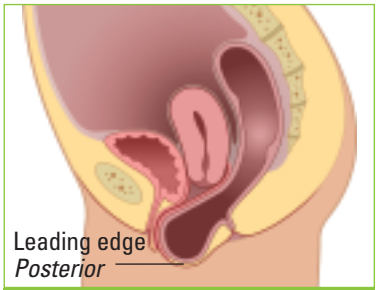
A prolapse occurs when pelvic organs drop from their natural position and sometimes protrude. There are several different types of prolapse. Often a woman can have more than one type of prolapse



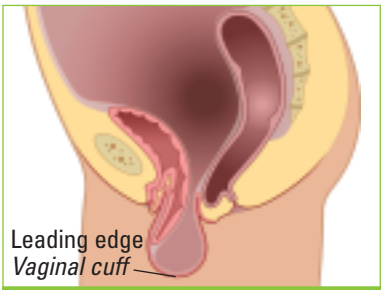
Uterine Prolapse



Anterior Wall Prolapse



Posterior Wall Prolapse

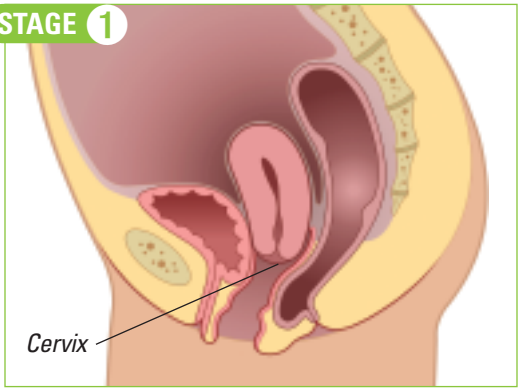


Vaginal Vault Prolapse

The following tabs present common types and stages of prolapse. See the inside front cover to learn more about the pelvic organ prolapse quantification (POP-Q) exam.

Uterine Prolapse

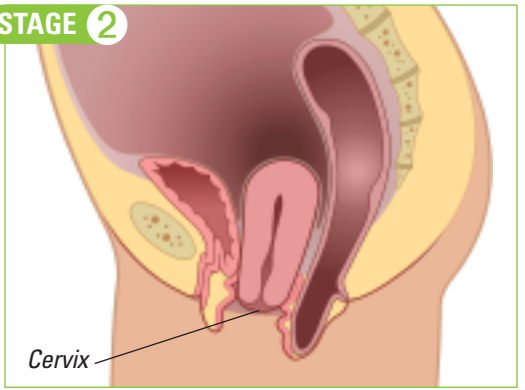
STAGE 1



POP-Q Measurements

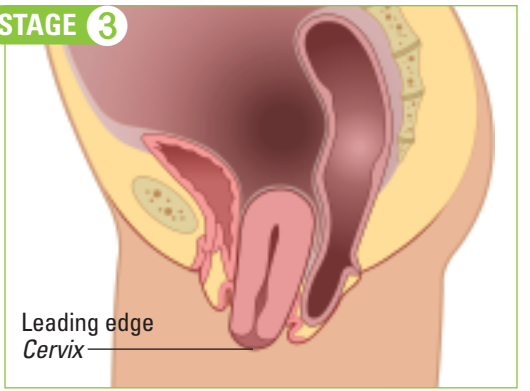
Aa	-2
Ba	-2
C	-6
D	-8
pb	3
gh	3
Ap	-2
Bp	-2
tvl	10

STAGE 2



Aa	+1
Ba	+1
C	0
D	-2
pb	1
gh	4
Ap	+1
Bp	+1
tvl	10

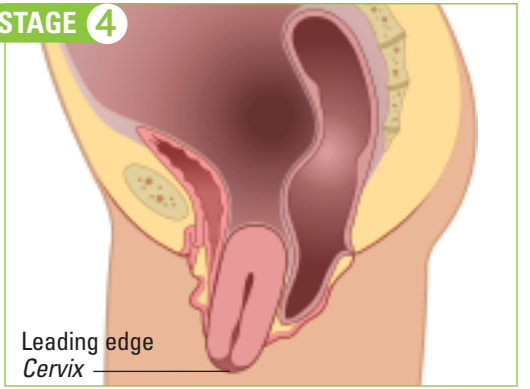
STAGE 3



POP-Q Measurements

Aa	+2
Ba	+3
C	+4
D	+1
pb	1
gh	5
Ap	+2
Bp	+2
tvl	10

STAGE 4



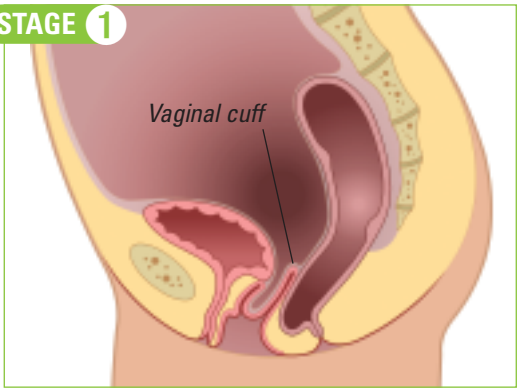
Aa	+3
Ba	+5
C	+8
D	+5
pb	1
gh	6
Ap	+3
Bp	+5
tvl	10

In **uterine prolapse**, pelvic support structures break down and the uterus drops into the vagina. Most often, other pelvic organs are also out of place.

UTERINE

Vaginal Vault Prolapse

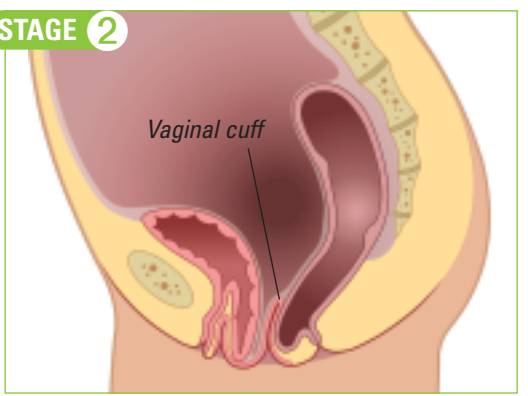
STAGE 1



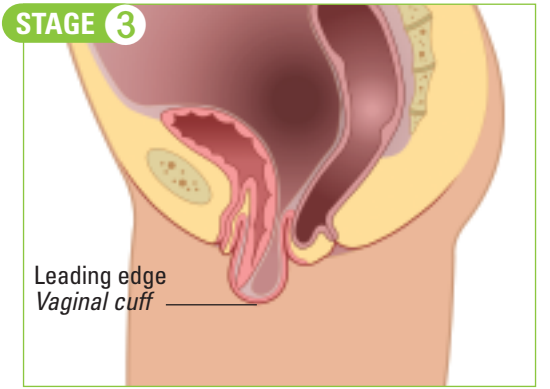
POP-Q Measurements

Aa	-2
Ba	-2
C	-5
D	NA
pb	2
gh	3
Ap	-2
Bp	-2
tvl	9

STAGE 2

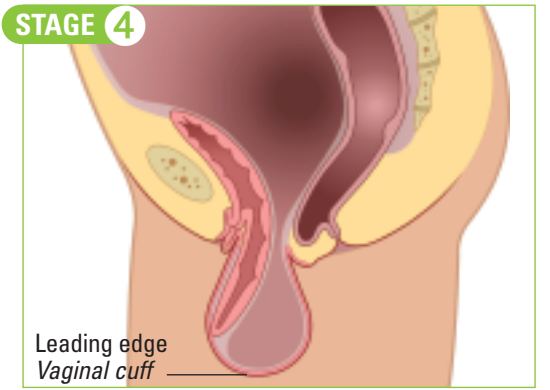


Aa	0
Ba	0
C	-3
D	NA
pb	2
gh	3
Ap	-1
Bp	-1
tvl	9



POP-Q Measurements

Aa	+3
Ba	+4
C	+4
D	NA
pb	2
gh	4
Ap	-1
Bp	-1
tvl	9



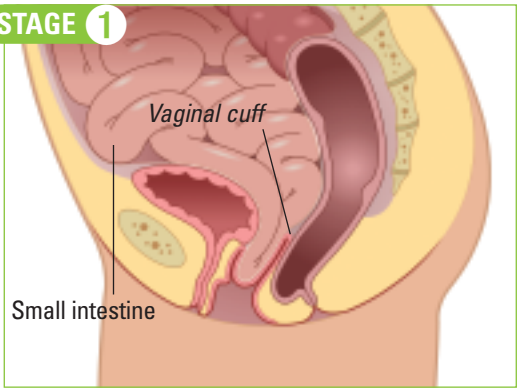
Aa	+3
Ba	+4
C	+7
D	NA
pb	2
gh	5
Ap	0
Bp	0
tvl	9

For a woman who has undergone a hysterectomy, the top of the vagina (or "vaginal cuff") can push into the lower vagina. This is called **vaginal vault prolapse**.

VAGINAL VAULT

Enterocele

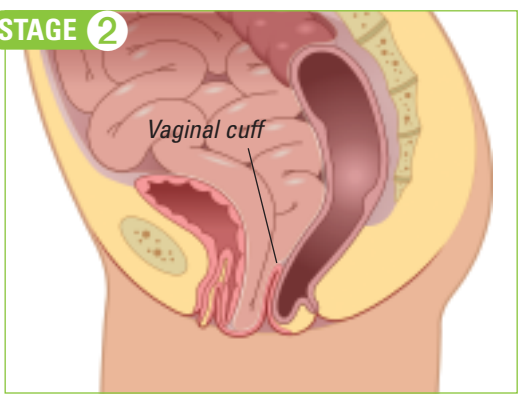
STAGE 1



POP-Q Measurements

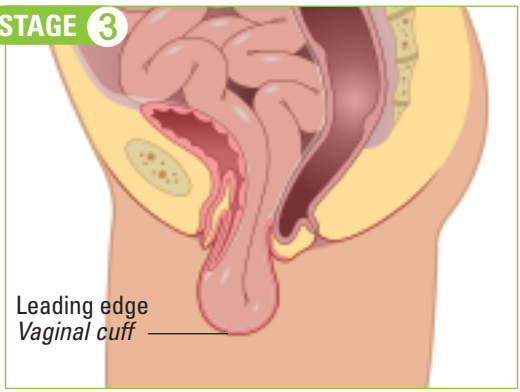
Aa	-2
Ba	-2
C	-5
D	NA
pb	2
gh	3
Ap	-2
Bp	-2
tvl	9

STAGE 2



Aa	0
Ba	0
C	-3
D	NA
pb	2
gh	3
Ap	-1
Bp	-1
tvl	9

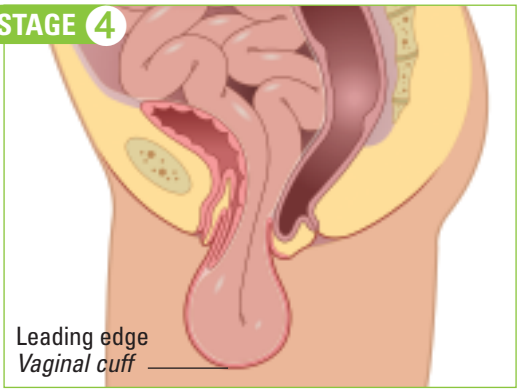
STAGE 3



POP-Q Measurements

Aa	+2
Ba	+3
C	+5
D	NA
pb	2
gh	4
Ap	-1
Bp	-1
tvl	9

STAGE 4

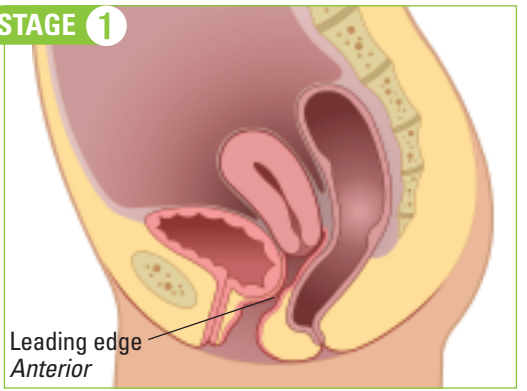


Aa	+2
Ba	+3
C	+7
D	NA
pb	2
gh	5
Ap	0
Bp	0
tvl	9

Women with vaginal vault prolapse often have a prolapse of the small intestine called an **enterocele**. In this type of enterocele, the small intestine drops through support tissue and into the vagina.

Anterior Wall Prolapse

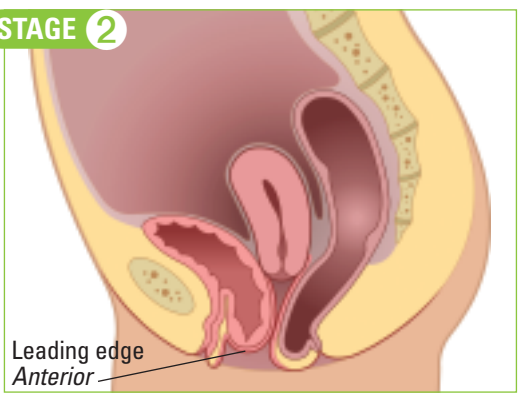
STAGE 1



POP-Q Measurements

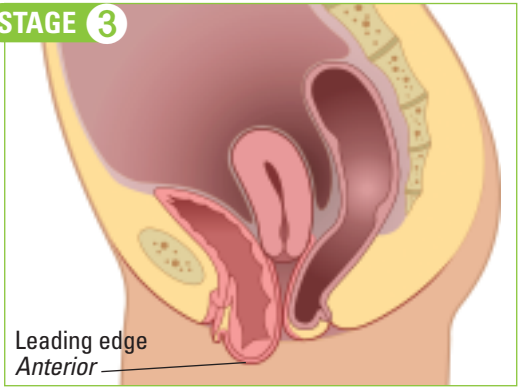
Aa	-2
Ba	-2
C	-7
D	-9
pb	3
gh	2
Ap	-2
Bp	-2
tvl	10

STAGE 2



Aa	-1
Ba	-1
C	-5
D	-7
pb	2
gh	3
Ap	-1
Bp	-1
tvl	10

STAGE 3



POP-Q Measurements

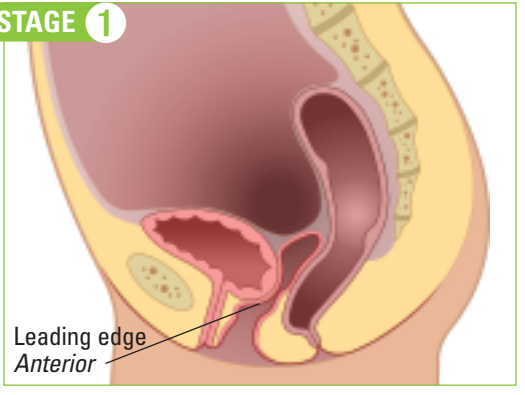
Aa	+1
Ba	+2
C	-4
D	-5
pb	3
gh	4
Ap	-1
Bp	-1
tvl	10

Anterior wall prolapse (or "cystocele") is the most common type of pelvic floor defect. It occurs when the anterior wall of the vagina loses its support. As a result, the bladder drops and rotates into, and often out of, the vaginal opening. Some cystoceles can cause urine leakage while large cystoceles can cause difficulty voiding.

ANTERIOR WALL
with uterus

Anterior Wall Prolapse

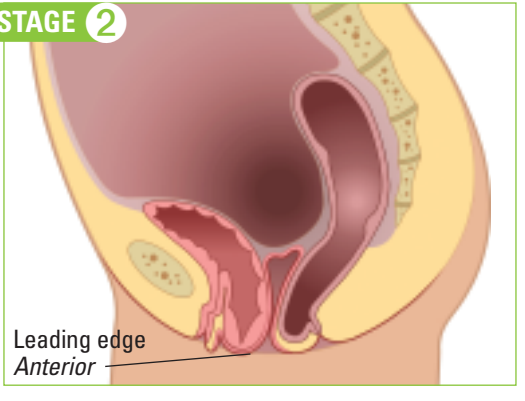
STAGE 1



POP-Q Measurements

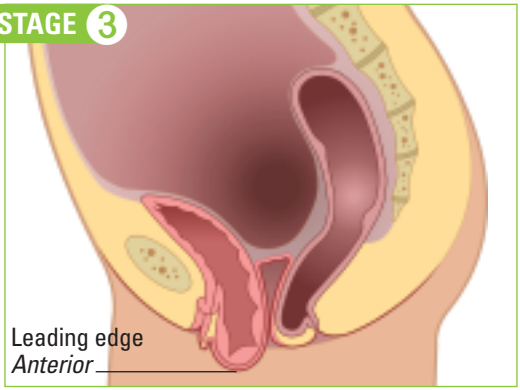
Aa	-2
Ba	-2
C	-8
D	NA
pb	3
gh	3
Ap	-2
Bp	-2
tvl	9

STAGE 2



Aa	0
Ba	0
C	-6
D	NA
pb	3
gh	4
Ap	-1
Bp	-1
tvl	9

STAGE 3



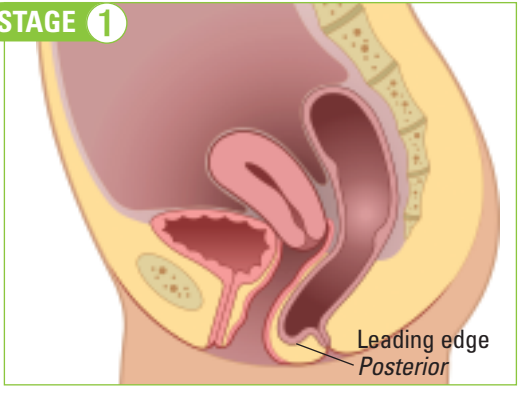
POP-Q Measurements

Aa	+1
Ba	+2
C	-4
D	NA
pb	3
gh	4
Ap	-1
Bp	-1
tvl	9

Anterior wall prolapse (or "cystocele") is the most common type of pelvic floor defect. It occurs when the anterior wall of the vagina loses its support. As a result, the bladder drops and rotates into, and often out of, the vaginal opening. Some cystoceles can cause urine leakage while large cystoceles can cause difficulty voiding.

Posterior Wall Prolapse

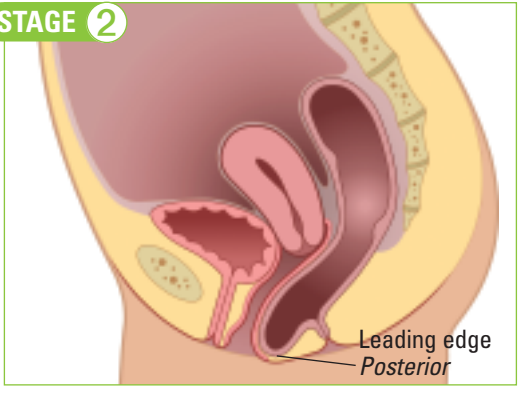
STAGE 1



POP-Q Measurements

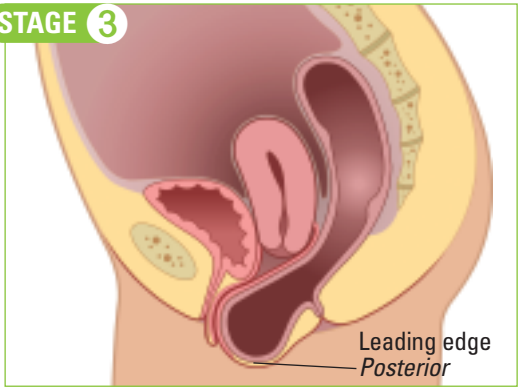
Aa	-3
Ba	-3
C	-7
D	-9
pb	2
gh	3
Ap	-2
Bp	-2
tvl	10

STAGE 2



Aa	-2
Ba	-2
C	-6
D	-8
pb	2
gh	3
Ap	0
Bp	0
tvl	10

STAGE 3



POP-Q Measurements

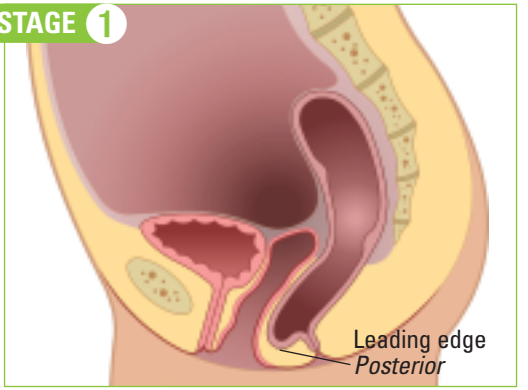
Aa	-2
Ba	-2
C	-5
D	-7
pb	1
gh	5
Ap	+3
Bp	+4
tvl	10

A **posterior wall prolapse (or "rectocele")** occurs when the posterior wall of the vagina loses its support. As a result, the rectum can bulge into, and often out of, the vaginal opening. A large rectocele can make it difficult to move the bowels.

POSTERIOR WALL
with uterus

Posterior Wall Prolapse

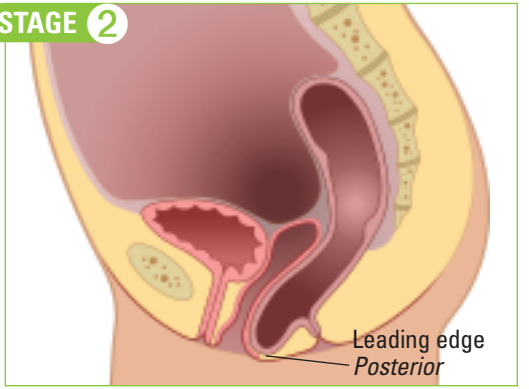
STAGE 1



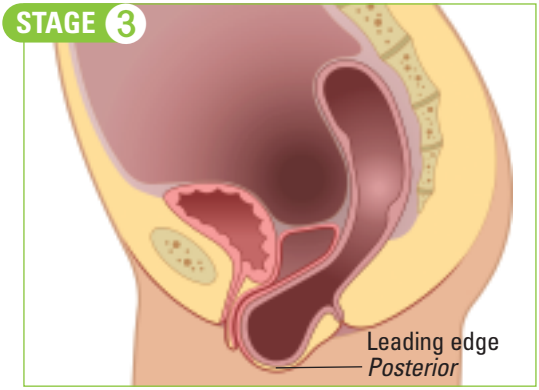
POP-Q Measurements

Aa	-3
Ba	-3
C	-8
D	NA
pb	2
gh	3
Ap	-2
Bp	-2
tvl	9

STAGE 2



Aa	-2
Ba	-2
C	-7
D	NA
pb	2
gh	3
Ap	0
Bp	0
tvl	9



POP-Q Measurements

Aa	-2
Ba	-2
C	-6
D	NA
pb	1
gh	5
Ap	+3
Bp	+4
tvl	9

A **posterior wall prolapse (or "rectocele")** occurs when the posterior wall of the vagina loses its support. As a result, the rectum can bulge into, and often out of, the vaginal opening. A large rectocele can make it difficult to move the bowels.

POSTERIOR WALL
without uterus

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